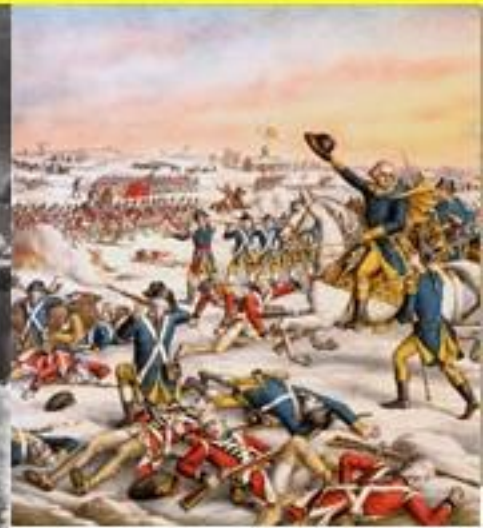


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 43

**COLONIZATION OF ASIA, AFRICA
AND AMERICAS - 3**

- 1** By 1820s, almost all countries of the Central and South Americas had gained their independence from Spain and Portugal.
- 2** Only a few colonies ruled by European countries were left in this part of the world.
- 3** Among these were Cuba and Puerto Rico which were still under Spanish rule and a few others under British, French, Dutch and Danish rule.



THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

1 The United States of America in the 19th century emerged as the biggest power in the Americas. She had extended her territories through war with Mexico and purchase of Louisiana, Florida and Alaska from France, Spain and Russia, respectively.

2 Within a short period after the Civil War (1861-65) which ended in the abolition of slavery, the United States emerged as a major industrial and military power in the world.

3 By 1900, her naval strength was third in the world.

4 The forces that had led to the emergence of imperialism in Europe and later in Japan also led to the emergence of the United States as a major imperialist power by the latter-half of the nineteenth century.



THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

- 5** After the U S.- Spanish War, the Philippines had become a U.S. colony.
- 6** USA had also taken Puerto Rico and Guam (in the Pacific) from Spain, and Cuba, though independent in name, had in fact become an appendage of USA.
- 7** When the scramble for colonies began, the leaders of USA declared that she must not fall out of the line of march.
- 8** They also claimed, like the European imperialist countries, the right to 'civilize' the backward countries of the world and, of course, to interfere in the affairs of other countries to protect their markets and investments.



MONROE DOCTRINE

- 1** During the period from the 1890s to the early years of the 20th century, the United States spread its control, direct and indirect, over South America and the Pacific.
- 2** In 1823, the President of the United States had proclaimed the Monroe Doctrine which warned the European powers against any attempt to extend their power in the Western/ Hemisphere.
- 3** In 1895, the Monroe Doctrine was given a new meaning.
- 4** There was a territorial dispute between British Guiana (now Guyana) and Nicaragua, and the British threatened to send troops against Nicaragua.
- 5** The US government forced Britain not to send her troops and declared that "Today the United States is practically sovereign on this Continent".



MONROE DOCTRINE

- 6** A new corollary was added to the Monroe Doctrine in 1904 by the then U.S. President, Theodore Roosevelt.
- 7** Britain and Germany had imposed a naval blockade of Venezuela as she had **failed to repay** the loan which she had taken from them.
- 8** Theodore Roosevelt forced Britain and Germany to lift the blockade and declared that the United States alone had the right to intervene in the affairs of her neighbouring countries if they were unable to maintain order on their own.
- 9** The United States took control of the finances of the Dominican Republic which she retained for three decades and occupied that country in 1916 for eight years.



MONROE DOCTRINE

- 10** In 1906, American troops were sent to Cuba and remained there for three years to 'protect' Cuba from disorder.
- 11** In 1909, American troops were sent to Nicaragua in support of a revolt which had been inspired by an American mining company.
- 12** The United States secured from the government which had been installed there the right to intervene in that country to protect American interests.
- 13** In 1915, American troops were sent to Haiti and remained there till 1934.



MEXICO

1 In Mexico, where the United States had huge investments, Francisco Madero, a popular leader was deposed with the support of the United States.

2 The intervention by the United States in Mexico continued for many years.



BIG STICK POLICY

- 1** The policy of the United States was described as the 'Big Stick' policy or Dollar Diplomacy and one of an 'international policeman'.
- 2** The extension of the U S influence through economic investments in the region is known as the 'Dollar diplomacy'.
- 3** The economic and political domination of South America was facilitated by the absence of strong governments in the countries of South America.
- 4** Many of these countries were ruled by caudillos, or crude and corrupt military leaders with armed gangs.



BIG STICK POLICY

5 They floated loans for ready cash and sold concessions to foreign companies to exploit the natural resources of their countries.

6 They served as markets for manufactures, and sources of raw materials for industrialized countries, particularly the United States, as well as avenues for investment of capital from these countries.

7 Most of the countries of South America, though political independent, came under the economic and political control of the United States.



PANAMA CANAL

- 1 One of the major acquisitions by the United States in this period was the Panama Canal.
- 2 A French company had started the construction of the canal in the Isthmus of Panama in Colombia (Central America).
- 3 The canal which would link the Atlantic and the Pacific Oceans was of great economic interest.
- 4 In 1901, the United States decided to undertake the canal project alone.
- 5 She paid \$40 million to the French company and entered into an agreement with the government of Colombia.



PANAMA CANAL

- 6** According to the agreement, Colombia was to give the United States perpetual rights to a six miles wide 'canal zone' across her territory in exchange for ten million dollars plus \$ 250,000 as annual rent.
- 7** The agreement was completely against the interests of Colombia and Colombia's Parliament refused to ratify it.
- 8** In 1903, the United States financed and organized a revolt in Panama and landed her troops there.



PANAMA CANAL

- 9** Soon after, the United States recognized Panama as an independent state.
- 10** The government of Panama signed a new agreement with the United States according to which the amount of compensation remained the same but instead of the six miles wide canal zone, ten mile canal zone was granted to the United States.
- 11** The canal was opened in 1914 and the canal zone has remained under the occupation of the United States since then.



HAWAI

- 1** The United States also extended her control in the Pacific during this period.
- 2** The islands of Hawaii had been important for American shipping and for trade with China.
- 3** The United States economic and commercial influence gradually increased in these islands and with the settling of Americans there, particularly as sugar planters, these islands became closely tied to the economy of the United States.
- 4** The United States had secured the exclusive use of Pearl Harbour as a naval station.



HAWAI

- 5** In 1893, the American residents in the Hawaii islands revolted against the queen of Hawaii and, asked for the annexation of the islands by the United States.
- 6** By 1898, Hawaii had been annexed by the United States. Later, it became one of the states of the United States.
- 7** The United States also extended control over other islands in Pacific.
- 8** There was rivalry among the USA, Britain and Germany over these lands.



Queen Liliuokalani

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